

When you consider the multitude of events that have to fall neatly into place before a baby is conceived, it's hard to believe that anyone can become pregnant. No wonder they talk about the miracle of life!

To become pregnant the following have to happen:

- **Your hormone balance** must be correct for the egg to develop.
- **Ovulation must take place:** if you don't release an egg, there is no way for fertilization to occur.
- **You need to have sex** at the right time in your menstrual cycle; sperm can last about three days in healthy cervical mucus, but if your timing is off, egg and sperm are unlikely to meet. In some cases there may be only two or three days each month when you can conceive.
- **Your partner needs to produce** plenty of good, healthy sperm that can penetrate your cervical mucus to reach the egg.
- **When the egg has been fertilized,** the blastocyst has to implant securely in the lining of the uterus.
- **The right levels of the hormone** progesterone must be produced by the corpus luteum to maintain the pregnancy.